

the same account are coming through other channel partners, it is a signal that the account needs a revival.

The process in terms of closing a sale is also rigorous in terms of the time it should be closed in. Three-month time is usually more than enough to close a sale, and that is the time usually allocated to a channel partner. We are likely to pass on the lead to alternate channel partners if the sale is not closed during this timeframe of three months.

So, it is a programme that does not define territories or create entitlements. The limited number of entitlements that are created are created for a limited time, and action has to happen within that time period. We realise that some products need a renewable cycle of one to two months and that is why we give three months to channel partners before passing on the leads.

How do channel partners avoid conflict of interest?

We have avoided conflicts by giving three months of time to a channel partner for working on a particular lead. Within these three months, the team at EESL partners with the channel partner to see that the lead matures from interest stage to the sale stage. We are there with the channel partners from the stage of solicitation to proposal and till the sale closes. Most institutions that partner with us understand that these are some brilliant things that we do to enable efficiency in them.

EESL also plans to invite all the channel partners for a once every month webinar, which will be an interactive session. This session can be used by the channel partners to come out with suggestions, and we will look into how we can support them via those suggestions. This is also a part of the regular training conducted by EESL for its channel partners.

Can you give a broad structure of the training provided to channel partners?

There are two components of the training. One is familiarisation with the products that the channel partners will be dealing in. We are also open to what our vendors tell us in the form of face-to-face communications. These usually entail demand for some other things and other programmes run by EESL.

We have also developed a kit that can help the channel partners convert a lead into a sale. This kit is given to the channel partners at a reasonable cost. The kit, for example, allows the channel partners to unleash a rooftop

programme. EESL is also thinking of enabling such kits for programmes that go beyond the rooftop programme.

The channel partners are also trained on how they can process their case. The specifics about the products and the programmes are also a part of the training. The channel partners are trained on selling a bulb, selling a specialised AC, and anything else that EESL deals in.

What happens if more than one channel partners submit the same lead?

Let's suppose that three channel partners report the same lead. In this case the lead would be deployed to the person who submitted the lead first. We have no basis to tell here who could be the strongest of these three channel partners. Similarly, a sales

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cycle is basically of three months. It is the time duration that we have established as good enough for somebody to close a sale.

These three months are also subject to movement, meaning that the customer shows interest. If the customer says that he is not willing to work with the channel partner because of some past issue or something else, then that to us is a pointer. We also check with the consumer how a lead is moving or not moving forward.

As a rule, the lead normally passes to alternate channel partners, unless a customer says that he is willing to work with the partner the lead had been already been assigned to. We make sure to give all the room to the channel partners to establish a dialogue with potential customers and also to develop and nurture relations with them. All the leads have to be generated by the channel partners.

Is there a cap on how many leads can a channel partner work on at a time?

No there is no cap on the number

of leads a channel partner can work on at a time. However, there has to be progress on each lead that is submitted by the channel partner. We do not know how many people are out there and we want to help all the channel partners create business for themselves and for EESL.

The proof of the pudding comes from the potential client itself as we meet and talk with the client along with the channel partner who had initially submitted the lead. Moreover, we do not pay for the leads submitted, we pay for the sales done.

What's in it for individuals to join as channel partners?

We are giving the channel partners an opportunity to make a living without them having to invest anything. There is also a social good that the channel partner is creating in the process. Every bit of energy that a channel partner saves goes a long way in helping save our environment.

It is also creating a value chain for entrepreneurs who want to enter and immediately start doing business. The pandemic has already pulled a lot of strings on the current employment levels in the country. This opportunity can actually be like a pseudo employment. The channel partners get to be the decision makers for their own business. Additionally, we are sure that the training we provide and assistance we give during sales will help in the professional lives of entrepreneurs.

As it is majorly about sales, is any sales experience needed to apply?

We are inviting people who do not have any prior experience of selling. In fact, people who are not from the electronics industry are also welcome to apply for the programme. We, the EESL team, are there to help them with the training and the overall sales process.

I must add here that selling energy efficient products is very very easy, as these are sold on the payback that the investor enables for himself. As the products come from EESL, reliability is assured, a point that most of the B2B customers like to get addressed before making any investment.

You do not need prior electronics or selling experience. EESL will inculcate that. You do not need any energy efficiency products experience. We, at EESL, will teach you that! **EFY**